2.5 Branding

A brand is a name, term, design, symbol, or other feature that distinguishes an organization or product from its rivals in the eyes of the customer. Brands are used in business, marketing, and advertising. Name brands are sometimes distinguished from generic or store brands.

2.5.1 Elements of Branding

Brand includes various elements like - brand names, trade names, brand marks, trademarks and trade characters. The combination of these elements forms a firm's corporate symbol or name.

i) **Brand Name** - It is also called product brand. It can be a word, a group of words, letters, or numbers to represent a product or service.

ii) **Trade Name** - It is also called corporate brand. It identifies and promotes a company or a division of a particular corporation.

iii) **Brand Mark** - It is a unique symbol, colouring, lettering, or other design element. It is visually recognisable, not necessary to be pronounced.

iv) **Trade Mark** - It is a word, name, symbol, or combination of these elements. Trade mark is legally protected by government. No other organisation can use these symbols.

v) **Trade Characters** - Animal, people, animated characters, objects, and the like that are used to advertise a product or service, that come to be associated with that product or service.

2.5.2 The Types of Brand

The types of brands include individual products, product ranges, services, organizations, individual persons, groups, events, geographic places, private label brands, media and e-brands.

i) Individual Brands

The most common type of brand is a tangible, individual product, such as a car or product. Brands can also be associated with a range of offerings such as varieties of toothpaste.

ii) Group Brands

Group branding happens when there is a small group of branded entities that have overlapping, interconnected brand equity

iii) Service Brands

A service brand develops as companies move from manufacturing products to delivering complete solutions and intangible services. Service brands are characterized by the need to maintain a consistently high level of service delivery. This category includes the following:

a. Classic service brands (such as airlines, hotels, car rentals, and banks)

b. Pure service providers (such as member associations)

c. Professional service brands (such as advisers of all kinds—accountancy, management consultancy)

d. Agents (such as travel agents and estate agents)

e. Retail brands (such as supermarkets, fashion stores, and restaurants)

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